

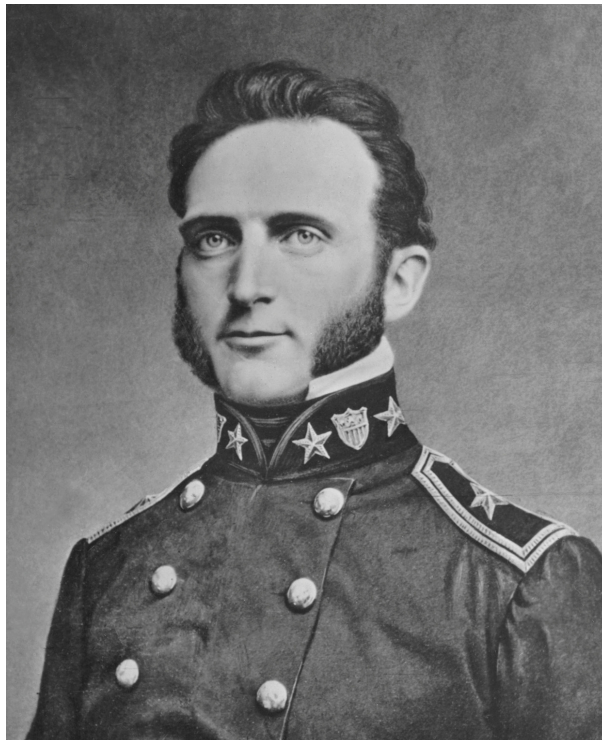
TIMELINE

■ **January 21, 1824** Born in Clarksburg, Virginia, son of an attorney. Both parents die by the time he is seven years old. He is mostly raised by an uncle at Jackson's Mill, Lewis County.

■ **1842-46** Studies at West Point, graduating 17th in his class of 59.

■ **1846-48** Fights as an artillery officer in the War with Mexico, distinguishing himself at the battles of Veracruz, Contreras, Chapultepec, and Mexico City. Starting as a second lieutenant, he ends the war with the brevet rank of major.

■ **1851** Resigning from the army, Jackson becomes a professor at the Virginia Military Institute in Lexington; he embraces Calvinism.



JACKSON IN 1852

■ **1853** Marries Elinor Junkin, who dies a year later; subsequently marries Mary Morrison in 1857.

■ **April, 1861** At the beginning of the Civil War, Jackson opts to join the Confederacy and is appointed an infantry colonel.

■ **July 21, 1861** Having been promoted to brigadier general on July 3, Jackson distinguishes himself at the First Battle of Bull Run in command of the 1st Virginia Brigade, earning the nickname "Stonewall."